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EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd
 D-88/3, Okhla Industrial Area,
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 Phone: 011-40596626,
 09650547770

Expert Advice for a Career in Data Analytics

► "I see two distinct paths for a career in DA. One could choose to focus on a career that is about extracting information from data or go further and choose a career that is about distilling business wisdom from data. The latter is harder, riskier but challenging and in the long run, more rewarding. Do not choose a career just because it has a buzz around it; choose a career that creates a buzz within you. You could be twice lucky, if the career you are interested in is also the one the market is interested in." —**Anand Sankaran, senior principal architect, Verizon Data Services India**

► "There are a lot of resources available on the Internet. All I can advise is that keep improving your skills in this area because there is a big shortage for right kind of talent in this area. Explore the platforms that deliver massive open online courses to develop your skills and knowledge about the area." —**Ashish Soni, chief analytics officer, Costarch**

► "Get your skin in the game. Learn as much as you can. Take up courses from free online resources such as Coursera, EDX, Amazon web services. Play with open data sets. There is a lot of scope for entrepreneurship with Cloud computing, analytics, big data and open data movements gathering momentum. Time to think big and make a good impact." —**Kaushank Nalin Khandwala, manager, Data Centre and Analytics Lab, IIM Bangalore**

cept every answer they hear, be both an analyst and an artist.

Key skills include logical thinking, analytical bent of mind, strong grip on mathematics, statistics and concepts of probability. Madhukar says, "Those who are comfortable playing with numbers complemented with data visualisation, good business understanding and communication skills will do very well."

Talking about AbsolutData, Datta says, "The major areas that we expect people to be strong are quantitative ability, problem-solving skills, good aptitude and lateral thinking." On the other hand, Soni notes, "The skill sets required to excel in this area include, interest in number crunching, good logic reasoning, knowledge and experience with some statistical package, programming knowledge and should be able to think out of the box."

Future

DA is a 23 billion dollar industry, informs Datta. She says, "Over the last decade, India has witnessed a change in even top tier strategy consulting companies using data-based decision

MAJOR CONTRIBUTORS TO THIS REPORT



Anand Sankaran
 senior principal
 architect, Verizon Data
 Services India



Ashish Soni
 chief analytics officer,
 Costarch



Kaushank Nalin Khandwala
 manager, Data Centre
 and Analytics Lab, IIM
 Bangalore



Sudeshna Datta
 EVP and co-founder,
 Absolutdata

making, surely the trend is changing. Eventually data-based analytics is going to be the space to watch out for!"

With encouraging career prospects and amongst the most well-paid careers, DA jobs surely seem to be the next big thing for engineers to consider. It is already beginning to revamp businesses and their ability to compete by helping them make smarter decisions. Analytics is the new career choice for those who want to stay ahead.

Analytics is not too much into tools or technologies, it is a method of thinking that permits the use of knowledge, tools and technologies to extract valuable insights from data. Analytics jobs and careers exist in most large companies in almost every industry vertical. ●

The author is a senior technical correspondent at EFY